

# FILM DOSSIER: BLACK PANTHER

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Phase 3 · Film #2 (Saga Film #19)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                                          |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 19 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #2)                                                    |
| Phase                  | Phase 3                                                                        |
| Real title             | <b>BLACK PANTHER</b>                                                           |
| Decoy / codename title | <b>"MOTHERLAND"</b>                                                            |
| Release date           | <b>Friday, July 8, 2016</b>                                                    |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                                            |
| Director               | Ryan Coogler                                                                   |
| Rating / runtime       | <b>PG-13 · 158 minutes</b>                                                     |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>royal succession drama / Afrofuturist epic</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                        |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>CHADWICK BOSEMAN.</b> The Black Panther franchise is his. |

| Character                                        | Actor             | Age at release |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------|
| T'Challa / Black Panther                         | Chadwick Boseman  | 39             |
| N'Jadaka / Erik Killmonger                       | Michael B. Jordan | 29             |
| Nakia (of the Dora Milaje)                       | Lupita Nyong'o    | 33             |
| Okoye (of the Dora Milaje)                       | Danai Gurira      | 38             |
| Shuri                                            | Letitia Wright    | 22             |
| Queen Mother Ramonda                             | Angela Bassett    | 57             |
| Zuri                                             | Forest Whitaker   | 54             |
| W'Kabi                                           | Daniel Kaluuya    | 27             |
| M'Baku / Man-Ape                                 | Winston Duke      | 29             |
| Ulysses Klaw                                     | Andy Serkis       | 52             |
| King T'Chaka (flashbacks)                        | John Kani         | 72             |
| Reed Richards (cameo)                            | Pedro Pascal      | 41             |
| Stan Lee (cameo: a man at a casino bar in Busan) | Stan Lee          | 93             |

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | <i>"Panther's Rage"</i> , <i>Jungle Action</i> #6–18 (1973–75), Don McGregor & Billy Graham: <b>Erik Killmonger</b> leads a rebellion in Wakanda, <b>throws T'Challa over Warrior Falls</b> , and T'Challa comes back to fight for his throne. <i>Fantastic Four</i> #52–53 (1966), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby: T'Challa's debut, <b>Klaw murdering King T'Chaka</b> , Wakanda, vibranium. |
| Supporting comics        | <i>Avengers</i> #62 (1969, <b>M'Baku / Man-Ape</b> ) · <i>Black Panther</i> vol. 3 (1998–2003, Christopher Priest: <b>the Dora Milaje, Okoye and Nakia</b> ) · <i>Black Panther</i> vol. 4 #2 (2005, <b>Shuri</b> ) · <i>Jungle Action</i> #6 (1973, <b>W'Kabi</b> and <b>Zuri</b> )                                                                                                  |
| Nerf check               | ✅ <b>Killmonger beats T'Challa and throws him over Warrior Falls</b> , exactly as in <i>Jungle Action</i> #6. T'Challa wins the rematch through <b>will</b> , not a sudden power-up.                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                            |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | <b>96%</b> . "Panther's Rage" is adapted with its structure intact, and <i>FF</i> #52–53 supplies the backstory. |

### Straight from the page:

- **Wakanda**: an isolated, hyper-advanced African nation built on the world's only **vibranium** mound (*FF* #52).
- **Klaw murdered King T'Chaka** when T'Challa was a boy. **Young T'Challa destroyed Klaw's right hand** (*FF* #53).
- **The Heart-Shaped Herb** gives the Black Panther his powers, and **the Panther God Bast** chooses the king (616).
- **Erik Killmonger, born N'Jadaka in Wakanda**, was exiled when Klaw took his family. He grew up in the U.S. and came back **to take the throne** (*Jungle Action* #6).
- **Killmonger throws T'Challa over Warrior Falls** (*Jungle Action* #6). **T'Challa survives, and returns** (#6–18).
- **W'Kabi**, T'Challa's security chief, **wavers in his loyalty** (*Jungle Action*).
- **The Dora Milaje**, the king's elite guard (Priest).
- **M'Baku** challenges T'Challa for the throne, and **becomes Man-Ape** (*Avengers* #62).
- **Shuri**, T'Challa's brilliant sister (vol. 4).

### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| Nakia's 616 turn to villainy (as Malice) is held back | It's held for a sequel. She's loyal in this film. |

| Klaw's appearance is a cameo | He was the villain in *Ultron Unlimited*'s mid-credit scene, and this finishes his story |

### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character              | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Shown in this film                                                                                                                             | Held back (why)                                                        | Match     |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Black Panther</b>   | <b>The Heart-Shaped Herb: peak-human-plus</b> strength, speed, agility, stamina and senses; <b>genius scientist and strategist</b> ; <b>master of every fighting style</b> ; <b>vibranium habit</b> (a suit that absorbs kinetic energy); <b>king of the richest nation on Earth</b> ( <i>FF</i> #52) | All of it: outruns a speeding car on foot, climbs a sheer cliff, beats M'Baku in ritual combat, out-strategizes Killmonger in the final battle | His <b>Avengers-level</b> leadership (on 616 he's an Avenger from #52) | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Killmonger</b>      | Peak-human <b>genius</b> ; expert tactician, martial artist and marksman; later empowered by the <b>Heart-Shaped Herb</b> ( <i>Jungle Action</i> #6)                                                                                                                                                  | Takes the herb and <b>matches T'Challa physically</b>                                                                                          | –                                                                      | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Shuri</b>           | Genius scientist and inventor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Builds Wakanda's technology and T'Challa's new suit                                                                                            | Her own Panther mantle (616 later)                                     | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>The Dora Milaje</b> | Elite warriors                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Okoye's spear work                                                                                                                             | –                                                                      | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>M'Baku</b>          | Great strength; the White Gorilla cult                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Ritual combat                                                                                                                                  | –                                                                      | ✓<br>100% |
| <b>Klaw</b>            | A sonic weapon grafted to his wrist                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | A casino fight in Busan                                                                                                                        | –                                                                      | ✓<br>100% |

## 4. STORY

| Field                       | Entry                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Logline</b>              | The new king of the most advanced nation on Earth comes home to take his father's throne, and finds that a Wakandan exile with a claim of his own has come home first. |
| <b>Theme</b>                | <b>What does a king owe the world?</b> Wakanda has hidden itself for centuries. Killmonger asks whether it had the right to.                                           |
| <b>Villain / antagonist</b> | <b>N'Jadaka / Erik Killmonger</b> (main); <b>Klaw</b> ; <b>M'Baku</b> (a rival who becomes an ally)                                                                    |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: THE KING

- **Wakanda, Monday, April 25, 2016.** Two weeks after Civil War, **T'Challa** comes home to be crowned.

- **M'Baku** of the Jabari challenges him at Warrior Falls. T'Challa wins, and **saves him**.
- **Klaw** surfaces in **Busan**, selling stolen vibranium. T'Challa, **Nakia** and **Okoye** go after him in a casino and on a car chase through the city.
- Klaw's buyer shoots him and takes the vibranium. The buyer is **Erik Killmonger**.

## ACT TWO: WARRIOR FALLS

- Killmonger arrives in Wakanda with **Klaw's body** as proof. **He's Wakandan**: born **N'Jadaka**, exiled as a child, and the son of a Wakandan the royal family abandoned.
- He demands **ritual combat for the throne**.
- **At Warrior Falls, Killmonger beats T'Challa and throws him over the falls**.
- **Killmonger becomes king**, takes the **Heart-Shaped Herb**, and orders that **Wakandan weapons be shipped to the world's oppressed**.
- **W'Kabi** backs him. Okoye stays loyal to the throne, whoever sits on it.

## ACT THREE: PANTHER'S RAGE

- **M'Baku** has T'Challa's broken body, which the Jabari pulled out of the river.
- **Bast** speaks to T'Challa in the ancestral plane, and **his father** asks him: *"What will you do differently?"*
- T'Challa comes back. **Shuri** gives him a new suit.
- **The battle for Wakanda**: the Jabari, the Dora Milaje and **the whole nation divided**.
- **T'Challa vs. Killmonger** in the vibranium mines. **T'Challa wins**.
- Killmonger, dying, refuses to be healed: *"Bury me in the ocean with my ancestors who jumped from the ships."*
- **T'Challa takes Wakanda into the world**: an outreach center in Oakland, and a seat at the United Nations: *"Wakanda will no longer watch from the shadows."*

# 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | Monday, April 25, 2016 → Saturday, June 18, 2016.                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Where it's set          | <b>Wakanda</b> (Birnin Zana, Warrior Falls, the Jabari mountains, the vibranium mines) · <b>Busan, South Korea</b> · <b>Oakland, California</b> (filmed on location in South Africa, Uganda, Zambia's Victoria Falls, South Korea and Oakland) |
| Relative to other films | <b>Two weeks after <i>Civil War</i></b> . T'Challa's side in that conflict is part of the political pressure on him at home.                                                                                                                   |

## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **Wakanda:** its tribes, its traditions, vibranium, the Heart-Shaped Herb, Bast, the ancestral plane.
- **The Dora Milaje, Shuri, M'Baku, W'Kabi, Ramonda.**
- **Wakanda goes public,** which changes the MCU's geopolitics.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                           | How it appears                                                                                                                                           | Payoff                       |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Wakanda is open</b>         | The UN speech                                                                                                                                            | <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> |
| <b>The Fantastic Four</b>      | Reed Richards, who fought T'Challa years ago (616: <i>FF</i> #52), congratulates him on the crowning: " <i>No hard feelings about the jungle trap?</i> " | Future FF films              |
| <b>Vibranium on the market</b> | Killmonger's shipments are only partly recovered                                                                                                         | Phase 3                      |

### Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed                  | How it appears                                                                                                                                           | What it means                                         |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bast's warning</b> | In the ancestral plane, Bast shows T'Challa a vision: <b>half the stars in the sky going out at once.</b> " <i>The Titan's gift. Be ready, my son.</i> " | <b>The snap is coming,</b> and Wakanda will be needed |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                         | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mid-credit scene</b>       | ✅ " <b>THE UNITED NATIONS.</b> " T'Challa finishes his speech. A delegate scoffs: " <i>What can a nation of farmers offer the world?</i> " T'Challa and Okoye look at each other and smile.                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Post-credit scene</b>      | ✅ " <b>THE SURFER.</b> " A rooftop in New York at night. The <b>Silver Surfer</b> , trapped on Earth, feels something in the cosmos <b>shift</b> . He clutches his head and cries out: " <i>The Gauntlet... he's going to use it.</i> " On the next roof over, <b>Doctor Stephen Strange</b> watches him, with <b>his cloak moving in the windless air.</b> <b>CUT TO BLACK.</b> " <b>BLACK PANTHER WILL RETURN.</b> " |
| <b>Secret shoot codenames</b> | Mid-credit: " <b>GENERAL ASSEMBLY.</b> " Post-credit: " <b>ROOFTOP.</b> "                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

## CHECKLIST

- ☒ Comic(s) adapted · ☒ Comic Accuracy Report + powers · ☒ Real and decoy titles · ☒ What it's about · ☒ Villain · ☒ Post-credit scenes · ☒ The film's own world-building · ☒ MCU world-building · ☒ Big Bad setup · ☒ Whose franchise · ☒ When and where in the timeline